

MADAuthor User Manual

A detailed guide to the AI-assisted book authoring, publishing, cover, export, and operations platform.

This manual describes the application as implemented in the current MADAuthor repository: Angular web app, .NET 8 API, SQL Server persistence, Hangfire jobs, SignalR notifications, cover tooling, file uploads, exports, translations, and the MAD Cloud operator queue.

1. What MADAuthor Is

MADAuthor is an AI-assisted book production workspace for people who need to turn ideas, notes, sermons, courses, manuscripts, interviews, or source files into publishable book projects. It is not only a writing prompt screen. It manages the full lifecycle: intake, planning, chapter generation, review, continuity checks, metadata, cover selection, exports, translations, and operational monitoring.

The application has three major faces: the author-facing web app, the API and background job platform, and the administrative/operator tools. Authors work with projects and book content. The API owns identity, data, storage, export rendering, and realtime updates. Admins monitor AI jobs, scheduled work, and the MAD Cloud task queue.

Area	What it does
Author workspace	Create projects, upload source material, approve outlines, review chapters, manage characters, choose covers, edit metadata, export files, and read the manuscript.
AI pipeline	Plans the book, researches when needed, drafts chapters, edits text, checks continuity, prepares publisher metadata, suggests cover direction, and can produce marketing materials.
Publishing tools	Maintains metadata, descriptions, keywords, copyright/front matter, cover art, KDP/Ingram print-wrap PDFs, and downloadable exports.
Operations	Admin queue, worker heartbeats, Hangfire dashboard, health checks, Claude task queue, prompt templates, scanner/worker toggles, and deployment workflow.

2. Main Users and Permissions

MADAuthor is role-aware. A normal author should only see their own company/projects. Admin and Owner users can access operational screens that ordinary authors should not see.

- Authors and creators** create book projects, upload material, review generated content, and export publishable files.
- Coaches, churches, consultants, and course creators** can use the intake formats to turn teaching material, sermons, training notes, workshops, or transcripts into books and companion products.
- Admins and Owners** use queue dashboards, worker controls, prompt template management, health checks, and deployment-related tools.
- Workers** are not human app users. They claim queued jobs, write progress, persist generated results, and mark jobs complete or failed.

Security is based on JWT access tokens and httpOnly refresh tokens. Company and membership records provide tenant isolation. File downloads and generated assets are routed through the API rather than exposed as unprotected public folders.

3. Application Map

Route or screen	Purpose	
/	/home	Public landing page for t
/login, /register, /confirm-email	Account access, new user registration, and email confirmation.	
/dashboard	Authenticated landing area with project status and quick access into active work.	
/books	Book library and project list.	
/books/new	Four-step project creation wizard.	
/books/:id	Main book workspace: outline, chapters, metadata, covers, translations, exports, assets, and progress.	
/books/:id/read	Immersive manuscript reader with chapter and page navigation.	
/admin/queue	AI job queue and worker heartbeat dashboard.	
/admin/claude	MAD Cloud operator queue for development/operations tasks, templates, imports, and deploy workflow.	

The author spends most time in three places: the new-book wizard, the book detail workspace, and the reader. The admin spends most time in the queue and MAD Cloud pages.

4. Creating a Book Project

The new-book wizard is intentionally structured. It captures enough information for the AI pipeline to plan and write coherently before any long-running job is queued.

Step 1 - Project

The project step captures the title, subtitle, genre, whether the book is fiction or nonfiction, the intended audience, and the basic project identity. Once this step is complete, MADAuthor can create a draft project record so uploads and later settings have a project to attach to.

- Use the title and subtitle fields as working values. They can be refined later by the Publisher metadata agent.
- Set the genre and fiction/nonfiction type carefully. These values influence outline structure, voice, metadata, and cover search prompts.
- Audience should be concrete. 'New managers in manufacturing' is more useful than 'everyone'.

Step 2 - Style

The style step captures creative direction: tone, point of view, target chapter length, target word count, reading level, themes, and other writing controls. These values become part of the BookRequest variables used by the prompt templates.

- Tone guides the feel of the writing, such as warm, practical, academic, devotional, cinematic, humorous, direct, or inspirational.
- Point of view matters for memoir, fiction, business books, and instructional books. The pipeline should know whether it is writing first person, third person, or a guide-style voice.
- Target word count and chapter length help the Planner and Writer agents decide chapter count and depth.
- Themes and keywords help the AI keep emphasis consistent across the manuscript and later metadata.

Step 3 - Content

The content step is the intake heart of MADAuthor. The user selects a request type and supplies the raw material that the book should be based on.

Request type	Best use
Idea	Start from a concept, market angle, theme, or book premise.
Outline	Start from an existing chapter structure that needs expansion.
Half manuscript	Continue, restructure, or complete a partially written book.
Expand existing book	Turn a short book, booklet, or notes into a fuller manuscript.
Sermon to book	Convert sermon notes/transcripts into a devotional, teaching book, or study guide.
Notes to book	Use rough notes, voice notes, workshops, or planning material as the source.
Blog, course, journal, voice transcript	Turn existing content streams into long-form book projects.

Uploads support text and document formats such as TXT, Markdown, PDF, DOC, and DOCX, with a project upload cap of 50 MB per file. Extracted text is available to the AI pipeline so uploaded source material can be stitched into the request instead of being ignored.

Step 4 - Review

The review step lets the author confirm the project, style, content, and instructions before the AI pipeline is queued. This is the last cheap moment to fix unclear direction.

- Check that the project goal, tone, audience, and content type agree with each other.
- Add AI instructions for non-obvious requirements: denominational boundaries, citation expectations, forbidden topics, desired structure, or brand voice.
- Submit queues the AI work and returns the project to the main book workspace where progress can be monitored.

5. The AI Production Pipeline

MADAuthor uses a staged pipeline rather than one huge prompt. That makes the system easier to monitor, retry, and improve. Each agent has a clear responsibility and writes structured output back to the database.

Stage	Result
Intake	BookRequest captures prompt, source text, uploads, variables, features, priority, and platform goals.
Planner	Creates chapter plan, narrative arc, section logic, research needs, and in fiction projects, core character scaffolding.
Researcher	Builds dossiers, facts, citations, and source notes where the request requires research or authority.
Writer	Drafts chapters in Markdown against word targets, style controls, and approved outline direction.
Editor	Improves grammar, flow, clarity, consistency, and readability without losing the intended voice.
Continuity	Reads final chapters together and flags contradictions, missing setups, timeline problems, duplicated material, or unresolved arcs.
Publisher	Creates KDP description, short description, keywords, subtitle suggestions, front matter, author bio scaffold, endorsements scaffold, copyright/ISBN page text, and category ideas.
Cover	Creates cover search/generation prompts and stores selectable cover assets.
Marketing	Can produce launch copy, social posts, email drafts, ad concepts, and campaign checklists.

Stage	Result
Exports	Renders downloadable manuscript formats and print-oriented outputs.

Progress is written to the AI job queue and pushed to the browser over SignalR. This allows the author to see status, stage, percentage, and errors without repeatedly refreshing the page.

6. Book Workspace

The book detail page is the central cockpit for an active project. It combines manuscript progress, outline approval, chapter lists, metadata, covers, translations, assets, and export actions.

- **Progress card:** shows current stage, percentage, status, and errors from the queue.
- **Outline approval:** lets the author inspect the plan before the system moves deeper into drafting. If approval is required, the pipeline should wait for it.
- **Edit details:** lets project metadata be corrected as the book evolves.
- **Authors and body font:** controls author attribution and export typography for reader-facing documents.
- **Chapters:** shows generated chapter summaries and content status. Chapters can be reviewed and regenerated when needed.
- **Assets:** lists uploaded files and generated assets with download/delete controls.
- **Exports:** queues and downloads document formats when content is ready.

A strong workflow is to approve the outline only after checking that each chapter has a distinct purpose, the order builds logically, and the promised outcome for the reader is visible.

7. Outline Editing

Before approval, the outline editor allows the author to rename chapters, reorder them, add new chapters, remove unwanted chapters, and edit chapter summaries. Chapter numbers are recomputed when saved.

- Every chapter needs a title before the outline can be saved.
- Summaries are optional but valuable because they steer chapter drafting.
- Reordering should be used to improve narrative or instructional flow before chapter writing begins.
- Deleting a chapter with meaningful content prompts for confirmation to avoid accidental loss.

For nonfiction, the outline should move from promise to foundation to application to next steps. For fiction, it should build tension, reversals, character choice, and resolution.

8. Characters

For fiction and narrative nonfiction, MADAuthor stores book characters so the writing and continuity stages can stay consistent. Characters can include names, roles, descriptions, relationships, arcs, and notes.

Character management is especially useful when the book contains recurring people, composite characters, interview subjects, leaders, students, congregants, customers, or fictional cast members. A character record gives the pipeline a stable reference point instead of relying on memory across chapters.

9. Cover Designer

The cover picker combines source images, AI generation, Unsplash search, template-based design, front/back previews, selected cover persistence, and print-wrap PDF output.

Capability	Details
Unsplash search	Search royalty-free images using title, genre, tone, or custom query. Photographer attribution is stored and displayed.
AI generation	Generate a source image from an optional prompt and style such as cinematic, minimalist, oil painting, photographic, illustration, or vintage book cover.
Template gallery	Choose from Bold Gradient, Classic Centered, Modern Minimal, Penguin Stripe, Magazine Block, Author Spotlight, Night Owl, and Golden Age design directions.
Live preview	Render front and back cover previews from the selected source image, book title, subtitle, author, and template.
Apply design	Persist the selected front cover design as the active cover asset.
Print wrap	Render a KDP/Ingram-style wrap PDF that combines back cover, spine, and front cover with page count and paper type controls.

A practical cover workflow is: search or generate several source images, select the strongest visual, preview multiple templates, apply the best front cover, then render a wrap PDF only after page count is known.

10. Publisher Metadata

The metadata editor exposes the Publisher agent's JSON output in an author-friendly way. It is designed to preserve unknown fields so future publisher data can round-trip without loss.

- **KDP description:** long HTML-capable product description, with a 4,000 character counter.
- **Short description:** concise hook suitable for website cards, ads, or sales pages.
- **Refined subtitle:** optional improved subtitle that can override the original working subtitle.
- **Keywords:** comma-separated keyword list, with a target of no more than seven KDP keywords.
- **Dedication and acknowledgements:** Markdown-friendly front matter text.
- **ISBN/copyright page:** copyright and publication text.
- **Author bio:** target 80-120 words, with live word count.
- **Endorsements scaffold:** placeholders for testimonials, reviewers, or launch quotes.
- **Find blanks:** scans for placeholders such as [PEN NAME] or [BETA READER 1].

This screen turns AI-generated publishing copy into editable production data. The author should replace placeholders, verify claims, check keyword relevance, and make sure all names and legal statements are correct before export or upload to retailers.

11. Reader Experience

The reader view presents a manuscript in a more book-like format than the management workspace. It includes a chapter sidebar, paged viewing, page flip animation, chapter and page navigation, keyboard arrow support, chapter word counts, and regeneration controls.

Use the reader for quality control. It helps the author notice pacing, repetition, chapter length, heading rhythm, and awkward transitions that are harder to see in admin-style tables.

12. Assets and Uploads

Book assets store source files and generated project files. The API supports listing, uploading, downloading, and deleting assets. Extracted text from supported documents can feed the book request so the AI pipeline has access to source material.

- Supported source types include common text and document formats such as PDF, Word, Markdown, and TXT.

- Files are stored through a storage abstraction. The current phase uses local filesystem storage under project folders, but the architecture can move to Azure Blob, S3, or another provider.
- File access should happen through API endpoints or signed URLs so tenant isolation and authorization are preserved.

13. Exports

MADAuthor includes renderers for multiple publishing and review formats. Exports are queued so long-running rendering does not block the browser.

Format	Use
PDF	General reading, review, proofing, and sharing.
Print PDF	Print-oriented interior output for KDP or Ingram-style workflows.
EPUB	Ebook distribution and reader apps.
DOCX	Word-based editing, editorial review, and collaborator markup.
HTML	Web preview, landing pages, or further conversion.
Markdown	Portable plain-text manuscript storage and developer-friendly review.

Exports depend on manuscript readiness. If chapters are still drafting or publisher metadata has not been produced, export buttons may be disabled or the output may be incomplete.

14. Translation

The book workspace includes translation controls once final chapters exist. Current UI options include Spanish, French, German, Portuguese, Italian, Dutch, Polish, Turkish, Arabic, Japanese, Korean, Mandarin Chinese, and Afrikaans.

Translation should be treated as a publishing workflow, not a magic button. The exported translation needs human review for idiom, cultural assumptions, scripture/citation conventions, legal claims, and market-specific metadata.

15. Admin Queue and Worker Operations

The admin queue shows AI jobs and worker heartbeats. It is built for visibility into long-running work that may span planning, writing, editing, export, and other tasks.

- Workers claim jobs atomically so two workers do not process the same job.
- Jobs move through states such as Pending, Claimed, InProgress, Completed, Failed, or Cancelled.
- Progress, stage, retries, and errors are persisted for troubleshooting.
- Failed jobs can be retried when the problem is temporary, such as a network interruption or provider timeout.
- Worker heartbeat data helps admins see whether scheduled workers are alive.

The API also exposes health endpoints, including readiness checks used after deployment. Hangfire provides a separate dashboard for deterministic background jobs such as exports, cleanup, notifications, and metrics.

16. MAD Cloud Operator Queue

MAD Cloud is the application-facing operator queue for Claude/Codex-style development and operations tasks. It is separate from the book-generation AIJobQueue. It helps manage internal tasks, prompt templates, attachments, scanner/worker toggles, and deployment workflow.

Feature	Details
Task list	Shows active, to-be-deployed, and terminal tasks with priorities, attachments, status, and relative updated time.
Statuses	Pending, InProgress, ToBeDeployed, Completed, Cancelled, Failed, and Deferred.
Priorities	Critical, High, Normal, and Low indicators.
Realtime updates	SignalR pushes task created, updated, and deleted events.
Attachments	Files can be added to new or existing tasks.
Bulk import	Imports a JSON array or an object with an items key; reports created and skipped tasks.
Templates	Stores reusable prompt/task templates and can open a new task from a template.
Worker controls	Toggles workerActive, scannerActive, and deployNext settings.

17. Architecture and Deployment

MADAuthor is currently structured as an Angular SPA under apps/web and a .NET 8 API under apps/api/MadAuthor.Api, with infrastructure, workers, prompt packages, and Codex desktop worker scripts in separate folders.

Component	Responsibility
Angular SPA	Browser UI, route guards, book workspace, admin screens, SignalR client, and API calls.
.NET 8 API	Authentication, project APIs, storage, queue orchestration, SignalR hub, Hangfire dashboard, and health endpoints.
SQL Server	Users, companies, projects, requests, chapters, assets, covers, exports, notifications, AI jobs, worker heartbeats, audit logs, and Claude tasks.
Hangfire	Deterministic background jobs such as export rendering and operational jobs.
Claude worker	Agentic planning, writing, editing, metadata, and operator task execution using the database as the contract.
FTP/Plesk deployment	Builds and uploads API/FE artifacts, recycles IIS using app_offline.htm, and warms health endpoints.

Production URLs are <https://madauthor.madprospects.com> for the web app and <https://madauthorapi.madprospects.com> for the API. Readiness is checked at /api/health/ready. The Hangfire dashboard is at /hangfire and should remain gated to Admin/Owner users.

18. Practical Author Workflow

Phase	Checklist
Prepare	Clarify audience, outcome, genre, tone, source files, and publishing goal.
Create	Use the four-step wizard and provide specific AI instructions.
Plan	Review and edit outline before approval; make chapters distinct and useful.
Draft	Monitor progress; wait for chapter generation and editing to complete.
Review	Use the reader; check pacing, repetition, claims, names, scripture/citations, and continuity.
Package	Edit metadata, choose cover, generate wrap if needed, prepare exports.
Publish	Verify retailer requirements, final proof, ISBN/copyright text, and metadata before upload.

The best results come from treating MADAuthor as a production partner. Give it clear direction, review each stage, and use the tooling to turn generated drafts into intentional books.

19. Troubleshooting

- **Login or refresh issues:** confirm the API URL and frontend URL match the current environment, and that CORS allows the web origin.
- **Uploads fail:** verify file type, file size, authentication, and server storage permissions.
- **AI job stuck:** check worker heartbeat, queue status, job errors, retry count, and worker settings.
- **Exports missing:** confirm chapters exist and are final enough for the selected export type.
- **Cover images missing:** check API asset URLs, selected cover status, Unsplash/API provider keys, and whether image endpoints require authorization.
- **Production health fails:** verify deployed connection strings, SQL reachability from the host, app pool status, and readiness endpoint response.

When troubleshooting production, remember that the database host is reachable from the deployed server, not necessarily from a developer machine. The readiness endpoint is the practical production connectivity check.

20. Detailed Intake Field Reference

The quality of the output is strongly tied to the quality of the intake data. MADAuthor stores the visible wizard fields and a richer JSON variable set behind the scenes. These fields help prompt templates adapt to different book types without hard-coding a single creative style.

Field group	What to capture	Why it matters
Book identity	Title, subtitle, genre, fiction/nonfiction, language, audience, and publishing goal.	These values drive outline shape, reader promise, metadata, cover direction, and export naming.
Voice and style	Tone, point of view, reading level, humor, emotion, spirituality, academic depth, practicality, and desired examples.	Keeps the book from sounding generic and helps every chapter feel like it belongs to the same author.
Length and structure	Target word count, chapter length, desired sections, workbook requirements, questions, summaries, and action steps.	Guides the Planner and Writer so the final manuscript has the right scale.
Source material	Idea prompt, existing content, extracted upload text, notes, sermon transcript, course material, or manuscript fragment.	Provides grounding. The AI should not invent what is already available in the user's material.
Publishing settings	Trim size, margins, typography, target platforms, ISBN/copyright needs, metadata, and retailer constraints.	Prevents late-stage export surprises and lets the Publisher agent prepare practical output.
Special features	Study guide, references, devotional, children's version, illustrations, audio, slides, teacher guide, translations, and marketing assets.	Allows the project to become a family of products rather than a single PDF.

A strong intake note includes the reader, the transformation promised to the reader, the author's authority, examples to include, boundaries to avoid, and any non-negotiable phrases or beliefs.

21. Book Type Playbooks

Different book types should be reviewed with different expectations. The same software screens are used, but the author's quality checklist changes.

Book type	Recommended workflow
Memoir	Capture timeline, major turning points, people, places, sensitive details, and lessons. Review for privacy, factual sequence, emotional arc, and whether every chapter earns its place.
Business book	Define reader pain, framework, examples, case studies, practical steps, and credibility markers. Review for actionable structure, repeated framework language, and claim support.
Devotional	Set theological tone, scripture translation preference, devotional rhythm, prayer style, reflection questions, and group-use expectations. Review every scripture reference and doctrinal claim.
Sermon series	Upload transcripts or notes, preserve the pastoral voice, identify repeated themes, and decide whether the output is a book, study guide, devotional, or all three.
Course-to-book	Bring modules, lessons, exercises, slides, and assignments. Review for flow because course order is not always the best book order.
Fiction	Define genre promise, POV, cast, world rules, conflict, plot beats, and desired ending. Review for continuity, motivation, pacing, and voice.
Workbook/journal	Focus on prompts, worksheets, spacing, instructions, answer areas, and action plans. Exports need layout review more than prose review.

22. Quality Review Checklist

- Does the outline deliver the exact reader promise described in the intake?
- Does every chapter have a distinct job, or do several chapters repeat the same point?
- Is the opening chapter strong enough to make the reader trust the journey?
- Are uploaded sources reflected accurately and respectfully?
- Are names, dates, places, organizations, statistics, scripture references, and quotations correct?
- Are placeholder fields such as [PEN NAME], [SPOUSE NAME], or [BETA READER] removed before export?
- Does the title/subtitle/description/keywords package match what the book actually delivers?
- Does the cover communicate the genre and reader promise at thumbnail size?
- Are export files named clearly and downloaded after generation?
- Has a human read the final output in reader mode before publishing?

A useful internal rule is: AI can accelerate production, but the author owns truth, taste, and permission. MADAuthor should make those review responsibilities visible instead of hiding them.

23. Data Entities in Plain English

Entity	Plain-language meaning
User / Company / CompanyMember	Who can log in, which tenant they belong to, and what role they have.
Author	The public or pen-name identity attached to a book.
BookProject	The central record for a book: identity, state, workflow stage, progress, target audience, genre, language, publishing goal, and deadlines.
BookRequest	The instruction package that starts or shapes AI work: prompt, source content, variables, requested features, status, and priority.
BookChapter	A planned, drafted, edited, or final manuscript chapter with number, title, summary, content, and status.
BookCharacter	A stable record for people or fictional characters used by writing and continuity agents.
BookAsset	Uploaded or generated files tied to a project, including extracted text where available.
BookCover	Selected or generated cover source/design assets, attribution, status, style, and designed output URL.
BookExport	A queued or completed export file such as PDF, EPUB, DOCX, HTML, Markdown, or print PDF.
AIJobQueue	The work contract used by workers to plan, write, edit, translate, export, or otherwise process the book.
WorkerHeartbeat	A signal that a worker is alive and when it last checked in.
ClaudeTask	The separate operator/development task queue shown in MAD Cloud.
AuditLog	Operational record of important actions for traceability.

24. API and Background Capability Reference

The API surface maps closely to user workflows. The names below are conceptual groupings rather than an exhaustive endpoint list, but they describe what the backend is responsible for.

Controller area	Responsibilities
Auth	Login, session/refresh handling, registration, email confirmation, superadmin/bootstrap flows, and user identity.
Books	Project creation, project details, chapters, outline approval/editing, regeneration, authors, project settings, and core book state.
BookAssets	Upload, list, download, delete, and text extraction for source files and generated assets.
BookCharacters	CRUD for character/person records associated with a project.
Covers	Unsplash search, AI image generation, selecting covers, rendering design previews, applying designs, and wrap PDF generation.
Exports	Queue, list, download, and delete generated export files.
PublisherMetadata	Read and update the Publisher agent's metadata JSON.
Translation	Queue translated versions after chapters are final enough.
Notifications	SignalR notification delivery and group membership.
Admin	Queue monitoring, worker heartbeats, failed job retry, and privileged operational actions.

Controller area	Responsibilities
Settings	Application settings used by MAD Cloud worker controls.
ClaudeTasks / ClaudePromptTemplates	Operator queue CRUD, attachments, import, statuses, templates, and task realtime updates.
Health	Liveness/readiness checks for deployment and database connectivity verification.

25. Admin Operating Rhythm

A production admin should have a small routine that catches most issues early.

Frequency	Checks
Daily	Open admin queue, confirm worker heartbeat, inspect failed jobs, confirm health readiness, and check recent exports.
After deploy	Visit the SPA, login, call readiness endpoint, test one authenticated API action, and confirm CORS/browser console is clean.
Weekly	Review job durations, storage growth, pending tasks, prompt/template changes, and user-reported quality issues.
Before major prompt changes	Run a small golden set: idea-to-outline, upload-to-outline, chapter draft, metadata generation, cover preview, export.
Before public launch	Confirm backups, admin/superadmin access, tenant isolation, SMTP, storage permissions, production URLs, and deploy rollback procedure.

Operational reliability matters because book generation can take time. Users will forgive a long job if they can see honest progress and receive a usable result; they will not forgive silence.